

# Product Incident Postmortem — November 2025 Login Friction

VistaPort Media Inc. — Product Data and Technology

|                     |                                       |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Document ID         | DR-060                                |
| Prepared by / owner | Maya Hart                             |
| Date                | 28 November 2025                      |
| Classification      | Strictly Confidential — Project Atlas |
| Incident            | NQ-17                                 |
| Type                | Login friction / availability         |

Blameless postmortem for the elevated login-friction and support-load incident observed during November 2025, tracked under incident code **NQ-17**. This is an availability / user-experience postmortem covering login success, reset-completion and support impact. It is not a security-incident report.

|                 |                                                      |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Incident code   | NQ-17                                                |
| Classification  | Login friction / availability — user experience      |
| Severity        | SEV-2 (degraded experience, no service outage)       |
| Primary systems | VPAuth, Trust Reset console, VistaMail sign-in       |
| Window          | Weeks commencing 3 November 2025 to 24 November 2025 |

## 1. Summary

During November 2025, users experienced elevated login friction: increased password-reset prompts, higher login-failure rates and longer sign-in times, with a corresponding spike in support contacts. The root cause was the planned **credential-hygiene resets and session invalidation** carried out under the Trust Reset programme, which required a very large population to reset passwords and re-authenticate within a short window. There was no service outage.

## 2. Impact

| Metric                            | Value                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Accounts forced to reset          | ~286m                                                                          |
| Active sessions invalidated       | ~511m                                                                          |
| Peak login-failure rate           | 5.1% (week of 10 November 2025)                                                |
| Peak weekly password-reset volume | 31.2m (week of 3 November 2025)                                                |
| Engagement effect                 | Short-term decline in email WAU and mobile MAU; partial recovery by period end |

*Counts are operational measures of the reset/invalidation programme and reconcile to the user metrics dashboard (DR-048) and VistaMail KPIs (DR-050).*

## 3. Timeline

| Date             | Event                                                                    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3 November 2025  | Trust Reset wave 1 begins; forced resets and session invalidation start. |
| 5 November 2025  | Login-failure rate and reset volume rise; support queues lengthen.       |
| 10 November 2025 | Wave 2 (main population); peak reset volume and login-failure rate.      |
| 17 November 2025 | Reminder waves; load begins to ease as non-actioners complete resets.    |
| 28 November 2025 | Metrics trending back toward baseline; postmortem opened.                |

## 4. Root cause

The proximate cause of the friction was the **planned credential-hygiene resets plus session invalidation** executed under Trust Reset. Invalidating a very large number of sessions simultaneously forced near-concurrent re-authentication and password resets, which mechanically increased login-failure rates (mistyped or forgotten passwords), reset volumes and support contacts. The friction was an expected by-product of the programme's scale and compression, not a defect in VPAuth or VistaMail.

## 5. What went well / what didn't

- **Well:** no outage; VPAuth and sign-in remained available throughout.
- **Well:** suppression and reminder logic eventually smoothed the tail.
- **Didn't:** waves were compressed, concentrating support load.
- **Didn't:** engagement recovery was slower than modelled.

## 6. Action items

| Action                                                 | Owner                                     | Status              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Smooth future reset waves over a longer window         | Maya Hart, VP Product, Identity and Mail  | Planned             |
| Improve self-service reset to cut support contacts     | Raj Malhotra, VP Engineering, Platform    | In progress         |
| Re-onboarding flow to restore logged-in engagement     | Maya Hart, VP Product, Identity and Mail  | Planned             |
| Complete VPAuth migration to simplify session handling | Nina Petrov, Head of Security Engineering | Roadmapped (DR-047) |

*Blameless postmortem. Authored by Maya Hart, VP Product, Identity and Mail. Incident NQ-17 — login friction / availability.*